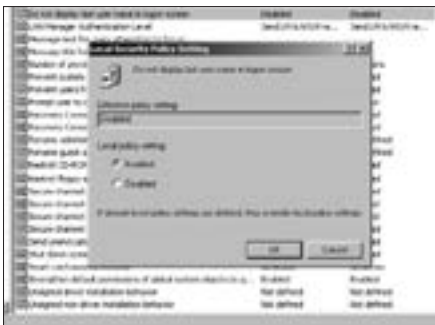


under Local Policies, select the “Rename Administrator Account” setting, and enter a new name for the account. Avoid using words such as “Admin”, but use an easily-remembered name.



Disabling display of last logged in user

ing it next to impossible to guess or crack. Enable log on Auditing so that you will know if somebody tries to access the account. To enable Auditing, go to Local Security Policy, and under Local Policies, select Audit Policy. In the right pane, open the setting Audit Logon Events and check both the Success and Failure boxes. You can review the Audit in Event Viewer (**Start > Run > eventvwr.msc**)

○ When logging on by pressing [Ctrl] + [Alt] + [Del], the login window will display the name of the last user logged in. For hackers, this is sufficient information to start cracking the user account. You can disable the display of the last logged-in username from Local Security Policy (**Control Panel > Administrative Tools**). Select Security Options under Local Policies in the left pane. In the right pane, find the setting “Do not display last username in logonscreen” and change the value to Enabled.

○ Encrypt your important files and folders with EFS (Encryption File System). Encrypting your files and folders will prevent hackers from reading encrypted data if they steal your hard disk, mount it on another system and take ownership of all the files and folders.

○ Create a dummy Administrator Account. Under **Control Panel > User Accounts**, create an account called “Administrator” with no privileges, and a 10+ digit password that contains letters, numbers and non-alphanumeric characters, making